

Learn the low level. Ship real open source.

Compiling a bright future through open source.

think teaches justice-impacted learners the part of software that actually sets them apart: **the low level**. How a computer really works, from true zero, up through the kernel, Rust, and driving real hardware, all of it offline on a locked-down machine. Then it does what a certificate never can. It turns that learning into **shipped, merged open-source contributions**: public, permanent, verifiable proof of what you can do.

think teaches justice-impacted learners real low-level systems skills (the kernel, Rust, and hardware) from true zero and offline, and turns that learning into shipped, merged **open-source work** that stands as public, verifiable proof of what they can do.

WHAT YOU LEARN

Scarce, in-demand systems skills: kernel concepts, Rust, and real hardware. Not the crowded web-dev track everyone else teaches.

WHAT IT DOES

Takes you from “what is a program” to DOOM booting on a display you drove from the bare metal, with no experience and no hardware required. Self-paced, offline, and it cannot get stuck.

WHAT YOU SHIP

Not a certificate that says you attended. Real open-source contributions with your name on them, merged into software people use. A portfolio, not a promise.

WHY SHIPPING OPEN SOURCE, FOR THIS AUDIENCE

A record that does not ask about your past. The review judges the patch, not the person. Contributions are public and merit-judged; nobody asks where you have been.

Proof you can point to. 83% of organizations weigh open-source contributions when they hire. A merged patch outweighs a gap in your history, because it is evidence, not a claim.

A door, and a community. The work introduces you, through on-ramps that already exist (kernelnewbies, the Linux Kernel Mentorship Program, Outreachy).

A certificate says: I showed up. A merged patch says: I did this. It is in the code, my name is on it, and it is still there.

You learn the skills the industry is short on, and you ship them where the whole world can see. You do not graduate with a promise. You graduate with a history.

Source: 2024 Open Source Software Funding Survey (GitHub, the Linux Foundation, and Harvard): 83% of organizations say open-source contribution is at least somewhat important for prospective hires.